

Software Bundles and Package Contents

What is a CD-Writer without CD-Writing software—or with software that can't do half of what the CD-Writer promises? CDs often get damaged due to problems with the writing software rather than the CD-Writer—its inability to properly recognise the writer or the operating system's file system and/or other intricacies.

Also, support for the wide array of formats is critical. Providing the best compatibility when it comes to operating systems and the ability to recognise a wide variety of CD-Writers is critical. Some software like Nero and Easy CD Creator have made a name for themselves in this arena.

The contents of the package are also a measure of the total value offered by the company. Since no software comes for free, getting high-quality software bundled with the CD-Writer is definitely an advantage.

Nero Burning ROM: This is probably the most popular CD-Writing software. The latest version now comes equipped with speed selection for erasing the CD-RW media. Another new feature that attracts immediate attention is the CD cover designer. Backing up your hard disk is also made easy.

The Wave Editor tool extends the functionality of the software by allowing you to load and edit music files. Reducing noise in tracks, increasing volume and giving other such effects is now not only possible, but easy as well. This version has features even for Mac users. It has support for Hybrid CD and HFS partition. You also have an integrated tool that adds support for virus scanning over the Internet.

The latest version of Nero has two additional diagnostic tools, Nero CD Speed and Nero Drive Speed. The installation

size is not very big and this is without doubt the most easy-to-use CD-Writing software. The popularity of this software among top CD-Writer manufacturers is reason enough for it to be the most widely recommended CD-Writing software suite.

Verdict: Nero has probably the best wizards designed for CD writing, making the whole process very simple. It also has a really large CD-Writer database, ensuring high compatibility.

NTI Professional: NTI professional has an interface that appears similar to Nero's. It comes bundled with a simple CD label creator. Apart from supporting normal CD creating modes, it has a very interesting feature—Live Audio Writing, which allows voice recording directly on to

a CD. NTI also has a built-in ISO and file comparing tool. Another



DVD Region Locking

As a part of DVD technology licensing arrangements, the world has been divided into six geographic regions. This means that movies from Region 1 (USA and Canada) will not play on a DVD player designated for regions 2 to 6. Effectively, Region 1 discs play only on Region 1 DVD players, Region 2 discs play only on Region 2 DVD players and so on.

A region code is embedded in the DVD-ROM drive. The first DVD disc inserted into a drive sets the region code for the drive. The drive's region can be changed four more times before it is permanently locked to a region. Inserting a disc that has a different region code than the drive's current code makes these changes.

Maintenance Tips

The drive

Do's: Your CD or DVD-ROM drives is probably the most used peripheral, when it comes to playing games, movies, songs or installing any software. In order to extend the life of your CD-ROM, one should use a lens cleaner at least once a month which is freely available in the market to clean the lens of the CD/DVD-ROM drive.

Don'ts: One common mistake that usually everyone does is closing the disc-loading tray by manually pushing it by the hand resulting in misalignment of the tray due to the extra force exerted by the human hand. It is recommended to close the tray by pressing the button from the panel thereby avoiding any sort of misalignments.



The Media

Do's:

■ The media, that is the CD-ROM is supposed to be long lasting however very often one finds that they fail to do so due to mishandling. The media should always be kept in a jewel case so that it remains free from dust and scratches.

■ If you find dust settled on the media then you should clean it with a soft clean cloth to prevent scratches, as the drive will take longer time in reading the dirty media or it may even fail to read it completely.

■ Always hold the media from the edges.

■ Always clean the media from the centre to the outer portion.

Don'ts:

■ The media should not be exposed to direct sunlight as it may damage the CD-Rom.

■ Never clean the media in circular motion.

■ Make sure you there are no fingerprints on the Media.